participated in the “people’s socialist” grouping organized by Venezuelan President Hugo Chávez, the Bolivarian Alternative for the Americas (ALBA), and played a key role in founding the Union of South American Nations (UNASUR), conceived in 2004 and formally constituted in 2008. When he and his counterparts created the IBSA Dialogue Forum in 2003, President da Silva characterized its goal as focusing the attention of the G8 industrialized nations, then preoccupied with terrorism and global economic weakness, on the concerns of developing countries. Brazilian Foreign Minister Celso Amorim added that China and Russia would be welcome to join as well.[236] Shortly thereafter, the Russians invited Brazil to the BRICs, whose ministers began meeting on the sidelines of the IMF-World Bank conclaves in 2006. All these South-South initiatives seemed highly successful.[237] In January 2009, da Silva shunned the annual “global capitalist summit” of the WEF in Davos, opting instead to appear alongside President Chávez at the “anti-Davos” World Social Forum, held that year in the Brazilian Amazonian city of Belém.

Since the Cardoso era, Brazil has engaged in increasingly activist diplomacy, including outside the region. When confronted with evidence of deviation from democratic practices in one of its South American partners such as Venezuela, for example, Brazilians consistently advocate behind-the-scenes consultations rather than public confrontation.[238] In the early twenty-first century, Brazil engaged in several significant extraregional diplomatic initiatives, notably its innovative and well-intended efforts in 2010, jointly organized with Turkey, to mediate the nuclear inspection standoff between Iran and the West, as well as its 2011 suggested modification of the 2005 UN commitment to a “Responsibility to Protect.” During the 2011 attack on Libya led by the United States and United Kingdom, rebel forces killed President Muammar al-Qadafi, which Brazilians found outrageous, leading Brazil to propose an alternative doctrine of “Responsibility for Protection” of civilians, which would promote humanitarian intervention and all-party peace talks, while disallowing regime change by force.[239] In both cases, the dominant Western powers accused Brazil of giving aid and comfort to dictators. Within Brazil, this response from the United States, as well as some of the other G7 powers, appeared unnecessarily highhanded, as well as hypocritical.[240]